don't have too much of RAM and the demands of the guest operating system are quite high, don't allocate too much of memory to the guest operating system. This will make the guest run slow but keeps the host operating system in good shape ensuring that the computer doesn't crash or freeze, losing all your data in the process if things go haywire.

Processor and RAM are the two most important factors effecting performance in virtualization. We've already spoken about hard disk space so we'll not get into that again. Just remember to allocate enough space for the guest operating system. If you're low on hard disk space, try to stick to the recommended minimum amount for the guest OS you plan to install. If you allocate a really low amount of space to the OS, things will fail anyway; if not, well, we don't really need to repeat the words "low performance" all the time, do we?

The Guest and the Host

Till now we've been talking about the guest operating system and the host operating system. In case these terms still confuse you, remember that they mean the same thing in virtualization terminology as they do in the real world.

A guest is someone who is temporary, someone who comes, goes and maybe returns. He's not a permanent member of your home. You don't allow him access to everything you have in your home but still you want him to feel comfortable. This is similar to the operating system running inside virtual machine software (virtualization software) wherein you can switch on and switch off the virtual machine. You don't allocate all the resources to the virtual machine but still try to allocate enough to make it run smoothly. This signifies the word "guest" being used for the operating system being run inside a virtualization software.

The host is someone to whom the place belongs, one who welcomes and manages different guests. He's someone more authoritative and permanent in nature, someone who manages the whole show. He's someone who was there and will be there even if there are no guests. This nature signifies the real operating system installed on the system and hence, we use the word "host" for the operating system really installed on the machine. It's the operating system where you install the virtualization software itself.

Try to remember this terminology well and don't confuse them. In case you go ahead with virtualization, install virtualization software and guest operating systems inside them and fall into problems and want some help